

The five that actually get broken.

DO

- ✓ Leave one full cap height of clear space around the lockup, including in social crops.
- ✓ Let one element dominate every composition. Flat hierarchy is the tell of an undesigned page.
- ✓ Name the artifact ("your first-version scope", "the competitive read"), not the feature.
- ✓ Use Fira Mono uppercase at 0.18em for every kicker and metadata line, and nothing else.
- ✓ Show the product's real output, including when it is long and unglamorous.

DON'T

- ✗ Don't put Action Red on more than 10% of a screen, or on two unrelated elements at once.
- ✗ Don't use red for errors or focus rings. Errors are #C0392B; focus rings are #4A4040.
- ✗ Don't set display type at flat tracking. -0.05em, or it reads as a wireframe.
- ✗ Don't imply the product writes the app for you. It decides what the app should be.
- ✗ Don't ship a gradient hero, a glass panel, a sparkle, or a "Powered by AI" badge.

THE ANTI-GENERIC TEST

Before anything ships, ask whether it could be the brand for literally anything else. If yes, it is not done. A strong brand is a specific product plus a clear audience model plus a point of view. The restraint in this document is not a taste preference: a tool that sells direction cannot ship a hype-styled interface, so the argument dies with any one of those don'ts.

REGENERATING

```
build-symbol.py
build-wordmark.py
build-icons.py
build-tokens.py
build-book.py
```

In that order. Tokens derive from DESIGN.json, so the kit cannot drift from what the product ships.